ACTT 01 – FEB 2026

CONTENT ADAPTED FROM R2MR, RDOCS RESILIENCY TRAINING, STRIVE RESILIENCY TRAINING, CAPT. STEPHANIE SMITH

Team Dynamics

Outline

1. What is a high-performance team? Why do we care?
2. What does a high-performance team look like?
3. Personal considerations
    1. Stress management
    2. Focus/attention
    3. Your responsibilities in a team
4. Scenarios/vignettes

What is a high-performance team?

- A group of people who strive for excellence through:
  1. a shared common vision, goals, metrics
  2. collaborating, challenging, and holding each other accountable
  3. with shared leadership and mutual trust

Why do we care?

Increased mission success

Increased satisfaction

Increased resilience

Improved adaptability

Thinking about high-performing teams...

Creating a high-performance team

The Tuckman Model

Forming

The initial stage where the group comes together and starts to form. During this phase, team members are often polite, positive, and focused on understanding their roles, goals, and the tasks at hand.

Storming

Conflict and tension arise as team members start to assert their ideas, leading to potential disagreements and power struggles. This is a critical phase where many teams fail if they cannot resolve conflicts.

Norming

Teams start to develop cohesion as they resolve differences, establish norms, and begin to understand each other's strengths and weaknesses. Mutual respect grows, and team members accept their roles and responsibilities.

Performing

The team reaches a high level of performance, operating efficiently toward common goals. There is a clear structure, trust, and flexibility in how the team works together.

Your role in the team – Team Lead

Team Briefing – identify your team members

Assign roles

Clarify goals and climate

Direct care, monitor team dynamics, routinely provide summary statements

You may have to provide care if there is limited expertise or personnel

Lead (or co-ordinate) debrief

Provide support to team if able, ensure aftercare if required.

Practice self-care

CALM Leadership

CLEAR, COMPASSIONATE COMMUNICATION

ADAPTIVE AWARENESS

LISTEN TO TEAM

MANAGE TEAM TASKS AND CONFLICT

Your role in the team – Team Member

Team Briefing – identify your expertise and situational knowledge if needed

Perform your role/Remain flexible

Provide and request closed-loop communication

Provide feedback as needed

Participate in debrief – don't be afraid to speak up

Collaborate on solutions to issues you encountered

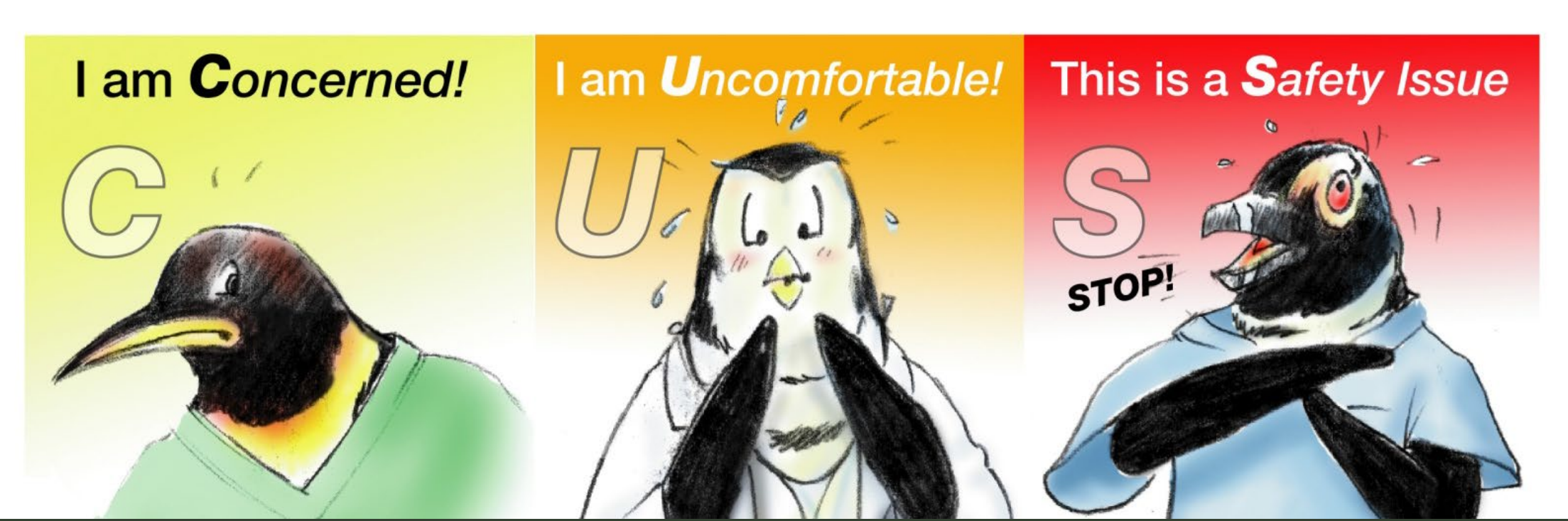
Practice self-care

Two-Challenge Rule

Invoked when an initial assertion is ignored…

- It is your *responsibility* to assertively voice your concern at least *two times* to ensure that it has
been heard
- The member being challenged must acknowledge
- Provide supporting information with second challenge
- If the outcome is still not acceptable
  - Take a stronger course of action
  - Use supervisor or chain of command

Two-Challenge Rule



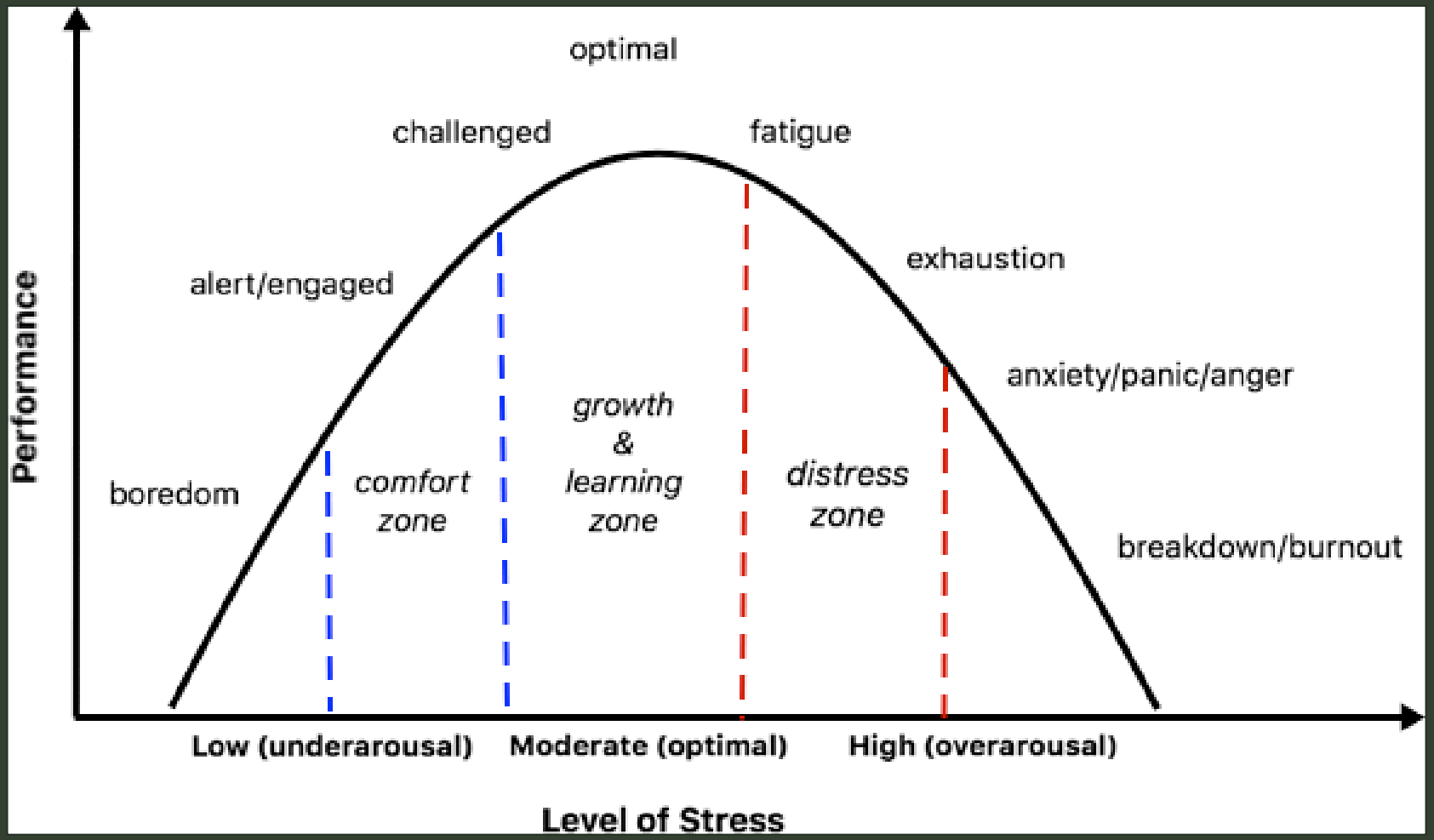
Vignette 1

- 70YO female Atrial Fibrillation
- Resident orders Diltiazem:
  - 0.25mg/kg bolus
  - 5-15mg/min infusion (not his usual but heard it from a cardiologist)
- RN asks if Resident to confirm the rate and he responds emphatically and defensively “Yes!”
- Hypotension/Bradycardia→ Arrest →Resuscitation unsuccessful

Vignette 2

- Nurse: “I’m concerned.” (invoking the Two-Challenge Rule.)
- “If I give the drip at 5 mg/min, we’ll double the bolus in 4 minutes & triple it in 8. I’m not sure of the dose, but it just seems too high. Can we look it up?”
- Drip rate corrected; 5 to 15 mg/**hour**
- Team leader thanks nurse for speaking up.
- Everyone goes home and has a great evening

Yerkes-Dodson Law



Managing Focus and Attention

Managing Stress

Tactical Breathing

- Inhale x 4
- Hold x 4
- Exhale x 4
- Hold x 4

Visualization

- Envision yourself successfully completing the task
- Remain calm and relaxed
- Create a vivid picture
- Anticipate "what ifs"

Managing Stress

Cognitive Reframing

- Catch it
- Challenge it
- Change it
- "mantra"

Progressive Relaxation

- Tense all muscles for 10-15 sec
- Relax
- Repeat 5 times
- Can do as a full body scan, moving between muscle groups

START Collaborative Debrief

SUPPORTIVE AND SAFE ENVIRONMENT

TEAM FOCUSED

ACKNOWLEDGE EXPERIENCE

REFLECT AND CONCEPTUALIZE

TAKE AWAY

Video

SQUAMISH SAR: TASK #223153
+ CRITICALLY INJURED CLIMBER
-TECHNICAL TERRAIN

Thank you

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